

BUDGET COMMITTEE MEETING – Wednesday May 27, 2026

1:00 p.m. – Anne Basker Auditorium

600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Budget Committee: Ron Smith, Colene Martin, and Gary Richardson, Marc Kirby, Chris Collins and Dorothy Yetter (Absent); Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Budget Officer: Arthur O'Hare

1) Open Meeting – Gary Richardson, Budget Committee Chair

Commissioner Richardson opened the meeting at 1:01 p.m.

2) Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

Budget Committee members reviewed the agenda and declared no potential conflicts of interest related to matters on the agenda. Committee Member Dorothy Yetter was excused from the meeting.

3) Department Presentations:

a. Clerk – Rhiannon Henkels Exhibit 1 PowerPoint Presentation

Rhiannon Henkels, County Clerk, presented the proposed Clerk's Office budget and reviewed the department's statutory responsibilities, including elections administration, recording services, passport acceptance, marriage licenses, and administration of the Property Value Appeals Board. Henkels provided operational statistics related to recorded documents, voter registrations, marriage licenses, passport applications, and ongoing efforts to digitize historical records and improve public accessibility. She highlighted implementation of the Property Recording Alert Service (PRAS), expansion of online services, and future plans to improve public education regarding Oregon elections and election processes. Discussion occurred regarding department revenues, fee structures established by statute, election security enhancements, and the potential acquisition of ballot sorting equipment utilizing Secretary of State grant funding. Exhibit 1 – Clerk PowerPoint Presentation.

b. Elected Officials Compensation Committee – Michelle Shaw Exhibit 2 Meeting Minutes Handout

Michelle Shaw, Human Resources Director, presented recommendations from the Elected Officials Compensation Committee. Shaw explained that the committee reviewed compensation information from comparable Oregon counties and developed recommendations intended to improve competitiveness while recognizing current fiscal conditions. Recommended adjustments included a ten percent increase for the Sheriff and District Attorney, a four percent increase for Legal Counsel, a three percent increase for the Treasurer and Surveyor, and no increase for the Assessor, Clerk, or Commissioners. Committee members discussed recruitment and retention challenges, compensation comparisons among similarly situated counties, and distinctions associated with state-funded portions of District Attorney compensation. Exhibit 2 – Elected Officials Compensation Committee Compensation Comparison.

c. Assessor – Chris Parton-Exhibit 3 PowerPoint Presentation

Chris Parton, County Assessor, presented the proposed Assessor's Office budget and reviewed the department's responsibility for maintaining assessment records, appraising taxable property, administering property tax functions, and maintaining mapping and ownership records. Parton reported that the office manages approximately \$17 billion in taxable market value and approximately \$10 billion in assessed value. He reviewed staffing levels, operational efficiencies, online services, and state performance benchmarks indicating the department continues to operate below recommended staffing levels. Discussion occurred regarding technology investments, artificial intelligence applications, customer service levels, staffing limitations, and the balance between maintaining current operations and pursuing future technological improvements. Exhibit 3 – Assessor PowerPoint Presentation.

d. Treasurer – Dustin Calvo Exhibit 4 PowerPoint Presentation

Dustin Calvo, Treasurer, presented the proposed Treasurer and Tax Department budget. Calvo reviewed the department's responsibilities for managing County funds, investments, tax collection, distribution of revenues to taxing districts, and maintenance of financial controls. He reported that investment earnings had

exceeded \$2.5 million during the fiscal year and that approximately ninety-one percent of current-year property taxes had been collected. Discussion occurred regarding investment strategies, staffing levels, office modernization efforts, internal controls, electronic payment processing, tax collection rates, and proposed improvements to public access and departmental efficiency. Committee members also discussed investment returns, staffing challenges, and opportunities to further streamline departmental operations through technology improvements. Exhibit 4 – Treasurer PowerPoint Presentation.

e. Surveyor – Peter Allen Exhibit 5 PowerPoint Presentation

Peter Allen, County Surveyor, presented the proposed Surveyor budget and reviewed statutory responsibilities associated with maintaining survey records, reviewing plats and surveys, preserving public land survey monuments, and providing public access to historical records. Allen explained that the department operates through both General Fund support and the Public Land Corner Preservation Fund. Discussion occurred regarding staffing levels, continued vacancies within the department, public access to records, digitization efforts, long-term preservation of historical documents, and the need to refill a Senior Department Specialist position to improve operational efficiency and customer service. Allen also reviewed trends affecting survey activity and recording volumes and discussed the relationship between survey services and infrastructure development throughout the County. Exhibit 5 – Surveyor PowerPoint Presentation.

f. Building – Frank Wharregard Exhibit 6 PowerPoint Presentation

Frank Wharregard, Building Official, presented the proposed Building Department budget and reviewed permitting activities, inspection services, code enforcement responsibilities, and departmental funding sources. Discussion occurred regarding construction activity, permit volumes, customer service improvements, staffing considerations, and efforts to maintain efficient turnaround times while complying with regulatory requirements. Committee members discussed the impact of development trends on departmental workload and future service demands. Exhibit 6 – Building Department Presentation.

g. Planning – James Black Exhibit 7 PowerPoint Presentation

James Black, Planning Director, presented the proposed Planning Department budget and reviewed land use planning responsibilities, development review activities, and statutory obligations associated with statewide land use requirements. Black discussed current development trends, planning workloads, long-range planning efforts, and departmental funding considerations. Discussion occurred regarding housing development, land use applications, staffing levels, customer service expectations, and future planning priorities within Josephine County. Exhibit 7– Planning Department Presentation.

h. Veterans – Lisa Pickart

Lisa Pickart, Veterans Services Officer, presented the proposed Veterans Services budget and reviewed programs available to veterans and their families. Pickart discussed ongoing efforts to assist veterans in obtaining federal and state benefits, outreach activities, claims processing, and coordination with community partners. Discussion occurred regarding the increasing complexity of veterans' benefit programs, demand for services, and the importance of ensuring veterans have access to available resources and assistance.

Emergency Management

Chair Richardson advised the board that Veterans Office has been moved down the list.

4) Budget Officer answers questions/provides requested information

Budget Officer Arthur O'Hare responded to questions raised throughout the departmental presentations and provided clarification regarding budget assumptions, personnel costs, internal service fund allocations, reserve funding, departmental expenditures, and revenue sources. Discussion occurred regarding staffing calculations, intergovernmental revenues, and operational funding considerations across multiple departments.

5) Public Comment (*limit of three minutes each*)

No public testimony was provided.

6) Confirm next scheduled meeting.

Chair Richardson confirmed that the Budget Committee would reconvene on May 28, 2026, to continue review of the proposed Fiscal Year 2026–2027 Budget and receive additional departmental presentations

The meeting adjourned at 4:02 p.m.

Exhibit 1 – Clerk – Rhiannon Henkels Exhibit 1 PowerPoint Presentation

Exhibit 2 – Elected Officials Compensation Committee – Michelle Shaw Exhibit 2 Meeting Minutes Handout

Exhibit 3 – Assessor – Chris Parton-Exhibit 3 PowerPoint Presentation

Exhibit 4 – Treasurer – Dustin Calvo Exhibit 4 PowerPoint Presentation

Exhibit 5 – Surveyor – Peter Allen Exhibit 5 PowerPoint Presentation

Exhibit 6 – Building – Frank Wharregard Exhibit 6 PowerPoint Presentation

Exhibit 7 – Planning – James Black Exhibit 7 PowerPoint Presentation

BUDGET PRESENTATION

FYE 2027

CLERK





PROGRAM PURPOSES & MANDATED SERVICES

Administration

Oregon Statutes including but not limited to Chapters 92, 106, 198, 205 & 246 - 260.

Const. V 16 V16, 9 VII 15 To facilitate and support all functions and duties of the Clerk & Recorder's Office.

Elections

The County Clerk is the Chief Election Officer of the County, charged by statute with the conduct of Elections. This involves managing voter registration (received over the counter, by mail, from Dept. of Motor Vehicles, from on-line and registration drives) per the mandates of the National Voter Registration Act (NVRA) and the Help America Vote Act (HAVA), establishing precinct boundaries and working with the cities on property annexation changes and adjusting district boundaries according to redistricting requirements.

The County Clerk also advises and administers the filing of initiative, referendum and recall petitions for proper forms and procedure per Oregon law and County Charter requirements. The County Clerk produces voters' pamphlets for the electorate in conjunction with HAVA requirements of voter education.

Recording

The County Clerk is charged by statute with the recording, custodial retention and public availability of land records and other records allowed for recording by law. These include, but are not limited to deeds, mortgages, reconveyances, plats, subdivisions, powers of attorney, contracts, liens, Josephine County Tax Warrants and satisfactions, mining affidavits and other documents affecting the title to real property. The County Clerk's Office issues and records marriage licenses. The fees are apportioned to Clerk, State Domestic Violence fund and County Juvenile Mediation Service. The office processes passport applications by Federal laws.

Board of Property Tax Appeals (BOPTA)

Oregon Statutes including but not limited to Chapters 309.

The County Clerk is the clerk to the Board of Property Tax Appeals, charged with appointing board members, accepting petitions, recording hearings and mailing orders, according to ORS and Department of Revenue directives.



Key Performance Indicators

	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27
Service Levels	Actual	Actual	Actual	Projected	Budgeted
Recorded Instruments	18,613	12,656	12,214	15,000	14,000
Marriage Licenses	557	507	547	500	550
Passport Applications	1,617	2,067	1,838	1,800	1,900
Voter Reg. Processed	3,546	3,085	2,951	3,000	3,000



Fiscal Year 2026 Accomplishments

- Conducted three Elections by mail.
- Produced 2 County Voters' Pamphlets.
- Record official records, plats, and subdivisions. Provide miscellaneous record services.
- Converted recording data to imaging to provide increased customer access and retrieval.
- Provided access to recorded documents online via the Clerk's Website, at no cost to the citizens. (We continue to index "older" documents regularly. We are currently indexed from 1951-present.)
- Updated & more user-friendly website that allows customers to order & pay for their copies via our website 24hours/7days a week; so that they can take care of their business with our office on their schedule, not ours.
- PRAS (Property Recording Alert Service) (as of May 2026 over 300 subscribers)



Budget Goal 1

Improve Efficiency, Transparency, and Public Engagement

- **Information Campaign-work with the new Public Information Officer to develop an online information campaign to inform the public of how the voting process works in Oregon.**
- **Continue to work to dispel mis/disinformation regarding Elections.**



Budget Goal 2

Ensure Long-Term Financial Sustainability of Core Services

- **Financial-Continually review expenses and research cost savings where possible. Research the cost-effective benefits of purchasing a Ballot Sorter to streamline signature verification, purchased through monies received from SOS grant. (Grant use for Election Infrastructure/Security improvements only)**
- **Continue to remain in compliance with US Passport regulations to continue generating revenue.**



Budget Goal 3

Strategic Investment in Public Safety and Community Infrastructure

- **Support-Provide support for Strategic investments in public safety.**
- **Continue to provide necessary recording services to the citizens.**



Five Year Vision

- Stay up to date on the latest technology when it comes to scanners, labelers, etc. so that my staff does not have to spend time during their day trying to troubleshoot their own equipment with customers patiently waiting.
- Research & purchase a Ballot Sorter with SOS grant monies
- Upgrade office workstations to ensure Ergonomic Compliance



Questions??

Thank you!



Human Resources
(541) 474-5217
500 NW 6th Street, Room 162
Grants Pass, OR 97526
www.josephinecounty.gov

Elected Officials Compensation Committee

Meeting Minutes

Date: May 20, 2026

Time: 10:30 AM

Attendance

- **Present:** Maegon Brazille, Jodi Robertson
- **Late Arrival:** Ken Beatty (arrived after voting concluded)

Compensation Recommendations

The committee voted on and approved the following compensation adjustments for 2026:

Elected Official Role(s)	Recommended Increase
District Attorney, Sheriff	10% increase
Legal Counsel	4% increase
Surveyor, Treasurer	3% increase
Assessor, Clerk, Commissioners	0% (No increase)

Assessor's Office Budget Presentation

May 27, 2026

Chris Parton, Assessor





Our Mission Statement

- To properly assess and value all taxable property within Josephine County.
- To maintain a property assessment system that complies with state requirements.
- To calculate the tax rate and total collectable taxes for each taxing district.
- To maintain the ownership records & maps of all assessable property for the citizens of Josephine County.



Who We Are

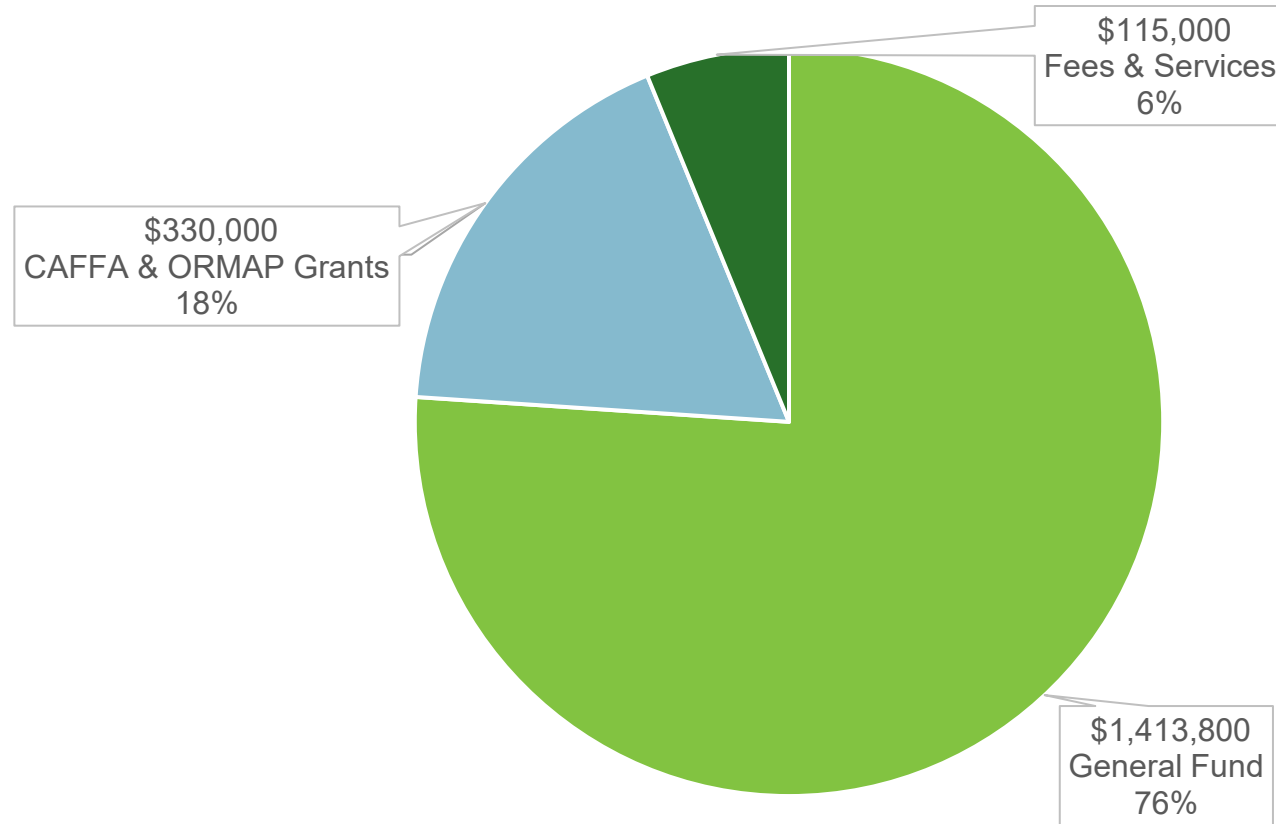
- First Josephine County Assessor sworn in July 7, 1856 - two and a half years before Oregon statehood.
- The phrase “assessor shall” occurs more than 250 times in Oregon statutes.
- 6 customer service & support staff (5 paid, 1 volunteer), 2 cartographers, 6 appraisers, 1 data analyst, 2 managers & 1 assessor.

What We Do

- Responsible for \$17B of taxable market value and \$10B of assessed value.
- Appraise 6,500 properties annually when fully staffed.
- Process 3,700 real property and manufactured home ownership changes.
- Process 4,000 business personal property returns.
- Provide assistance to 16 taxing districts.
- Provide customer service to 9,000 people annually.

*Approximate, rounded figures.

Our Revenue Sources



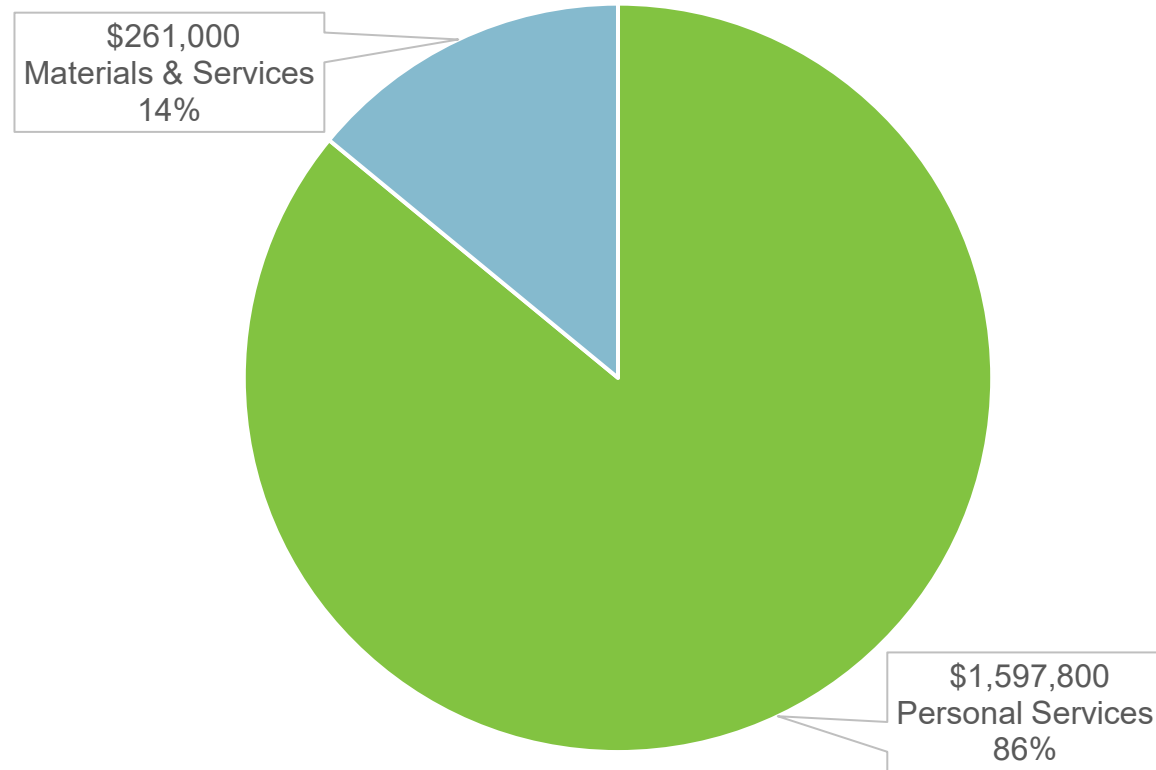
■ General Fund

■ CAFFA & ORMAP Grants

■ Fees & Services

*Excludes ISF @ \$115,000

Our Expenses

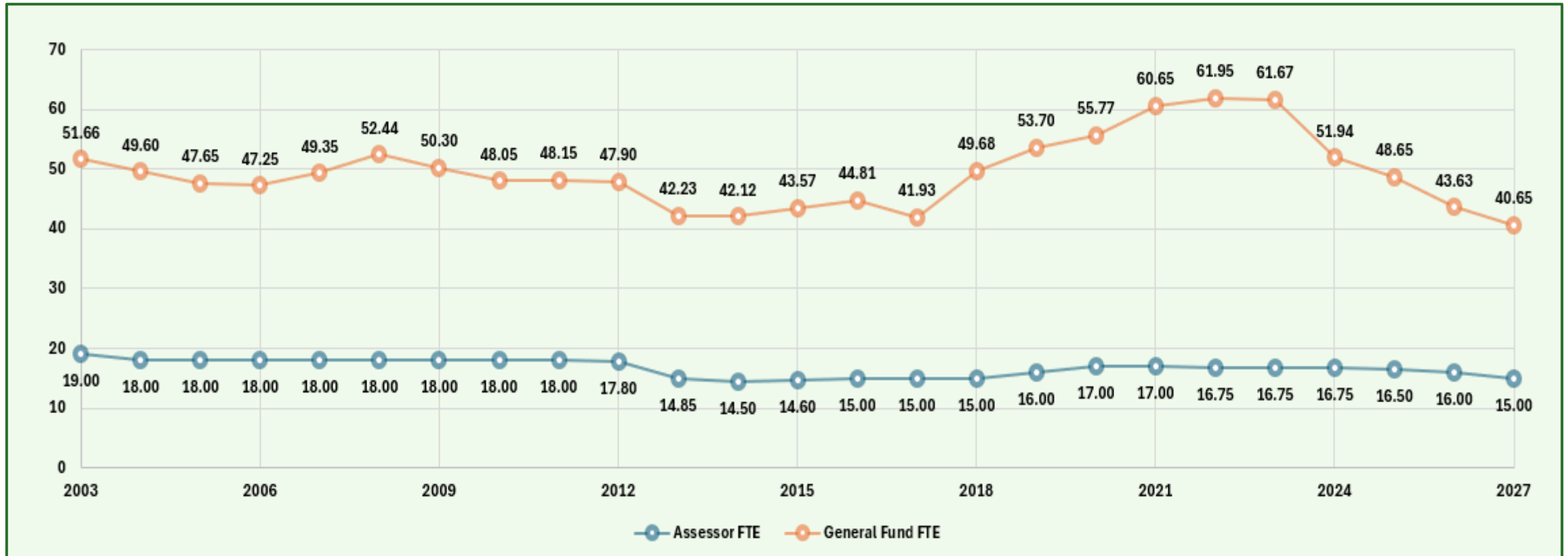


■ Personal Services

■ Materials & Services

*Excludes ISF @ \$115,000

Assessor & General Fund FTE History





Budget Goal 1 – Improve Efficiency, Transparency & Public Engagement

- Enhance service by improving access to data on our public access website.
- Improved efficiency by optimizing online resources including an online filing portal for businesses to file personal property returns and mailing address changes.
- Provide forms and applications online reducing the reliance on customer support staff and postal service.
- Operate at ~70% of Oregon Department of Revenue's (DOR) recommended staffing level.



Budget Goal 2 – Ensure Long-Term Financial Sustainability of Services

- State mandated program operates under DOR's broad supervisory powers under ORS 306.115.
- No one-time or temporary revenue sources are relied upon.
- CAFFA grant revenue relied on since 1989.
- ORMAP grant revenue relied on as needed since 1999.



Budget Goal 3 – Strategic Investment in Public Safety & Infrastructure

- Maintain minimum FTE.
- Forgo investments in technology such as oblique imagery, change detection, AI, etc. to free up general fund revenue for public safety and community infrastructure.

Five-Year Vision

- State Mandated Program.
- Optimize existing systems & technology and defer future investments.
- Maximize efficiency through strategic resource allocation to provide the best value to Josephine County citizens.



Questions?

Thank You!

BUDGET PRESENTATION

FYE 2027

TREASURY AND TAX



PROGRAM PURPOSE



The Treasury Division acts as the County bank and is responsible for the collection and distribution of monies.



The Treasury Division invests all Josephine County Funds and Treasurer's trust funds, including taxing districts funds.



The Tax Division collects all taxes assessed on real and personal property in Josephine County, for the benefit of the taxing districts.



MANDATED ACTIVITIES

TREASURY

- Receipt and account for all monies received by Josephine County. ORS 208.010 et seq.
- Maintain Bank accounts and make payment of County "orders". ORS 208.020
- Maintain accounting of cash in all funds in Treasury. ORS 208.070
- Invest surplus funds in approved manner. ORS 294.035 et seq.
- Distribution of payments to taxing districts. Excess of \$91,000,000. ORS 311.395
- Annual and monthly reports to County Board and Taxing Districts. ORS 294.155, 208.290
- Maintain Treasurer's records archives. ORS 192.001 et seq., OAR 166.030. et seq
- Maintain bond reserve accounts and remit payments to fiscal agent. ORS 288.040
- Distribute payments received from:
 - Federal Forest Receipts. ORS 294.060
 - Sale of tax foreclosed property. ORS 275.275
 - County Assessment and Taxation Fund collections. ORS 311.508
 - Abandoned Property Sales. ORS 90.425
 - County School Fund. ORS 328.030

TAX

- Prepare and maintain the tax roll database of 51,470 accounts. ORS 311.005 et seq.
- Send tax bills and collect payments ORS 311.250 et seq.
- Deposit tax collections with County Treasurer ORS 311.375 et seq.
- Manage collection of delinquent taxes ORS 311.405 et seq., ORS 311.505 et seq.
- Prepare annual statements and other reports ORS 311.531, 311.390 et seq.
- Manage foreclosure process 312.050 et seq.

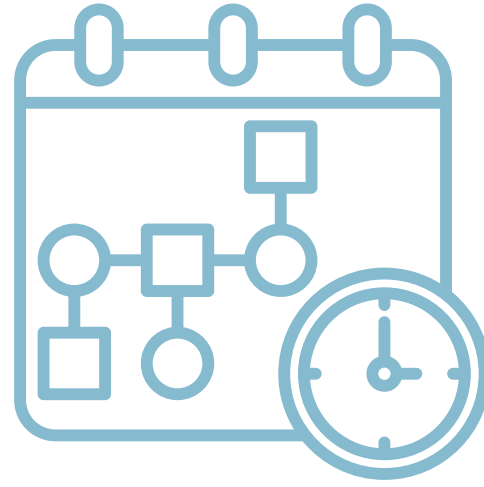
Budget Goal 1

Improve Efficiency, Transparency, and Public Engagement



ACH Process

Streamline the ACH process, in turn making the process more secure by ensuring checks and balances.



Daily Processing

Review, evaluate, and make necessary changes to the way that departments currently enter transactions that are processed by Treasury.



Information Accessibility

Develop ways to make financial information from the Treasury more accessible via the County website.

Budget Goal 2

Ensure Long-Term Financial Sustainability of Core Services



Investments

Continue to develop and refine a long-term investment strategy working with professionals in the field.

Budget Goal 3

Strategic Investment in Public Safety and Community Infrastructure

Capital Improvement

Make necessary structural modifications to the Treasury and Tax office to improve employee and public safety. In turn creating lasting, long-term internal infrastructure.



Capital Outlay



Workstation Ergonomics

As part of our Budget Goal 3 initiative Treasury is requesting funds to replace current workstation furniture with ergonomically sound options. This will help to prevent Workers' Comp claims for related ergonomic injuries due to non-ergonomic workstation furniture.



Key Performance Indicators

	2022-2023	2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027
Service Levels	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual (as of 04/27/2026)	Estimated
TREASURY					
Total Bank Credits	NOT PREVIOUSLY REPORTED			\$268,872,769	\$270,000,000
Total Bank Debits				\$264,796,239	\$266,000,000
Total ACH Payments	\$86,695,280	\$89,666,638	\$99,236,453	\$106,887,411	\$103,000,000
Total # of Bank Transactions (Credits + Debits – ACH Batches)	NOT PREVIOUSLY REPORTED			12,480	13,500
Total Individual ACH Payments (Previously Checks Processed)	9,251	8,187	9,500	11,941	12,500
Total Exceptions Processed	NOT PREVIOUSLY REPORTED			1006	1000
Average Portfolio	\$80,039,538	\$79,564,663	\$78,321,326	\$65,910,472	\$90,000,000
Interest Earnings Receipted	\$1,657,280	\$2,588,646	\$3,931,494	\$2,385,207	\$4,000,000
TAX COLLECTION					
Distributions to Taxing Entities	\$88,483,452	\$91,152,944	\$99,510,794	\$103,295,044	\$107,000,000
Tax Statements Mailed	57,394	58,261	53,391	60,659	60,000
Delinquent Notices Mailed	3,182	3,265	3,978	0	3,500
Active Bankruptcies (Average)	15	30	30	32	32
Register Receipts Issued	18,604	14,277	17,963	17,681	18,000
Lockbox Payments Processed	19,207	13,907	14,500	12,849	15,000
Fees Generated - General Fund	\$23,319	\$36,469	\$24,875	\$27,249	\$29,000
Refunds Processed/Issued	414	394	357	395	400
Refunds Issued	\$400,197	\$253,604	\$403,109	\$313,229	\$325,000
Simple overpays (after check clears)	1 week	1 week	1 week	1 week	1 week
Duplicate Payment (after payers agree)	1 week	1 week	1 week	1 week	1 week
Foreclosed Properties Deeded	9	5	0	0	5



Fiscal Year 2026 Accomplishments

- Over **\$2.5M** in returns as of May 1, 2026.
- **91%** of due taxes have been collected for the current year.
- Reduced the pain point of the automated phone payment system by working with the payment vendor to offer a **live agent option at no additional cost to the county or the public.**

Five Year Vision



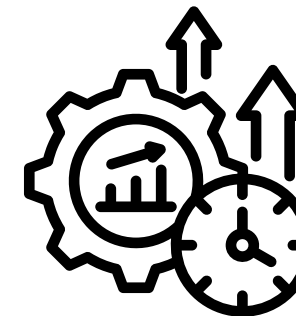
Continue to invest public funds to maintain a high level of interest income while focusing on safeguarding invested funds, liquidity, and maximizing return within confines of applicable laws and policies.



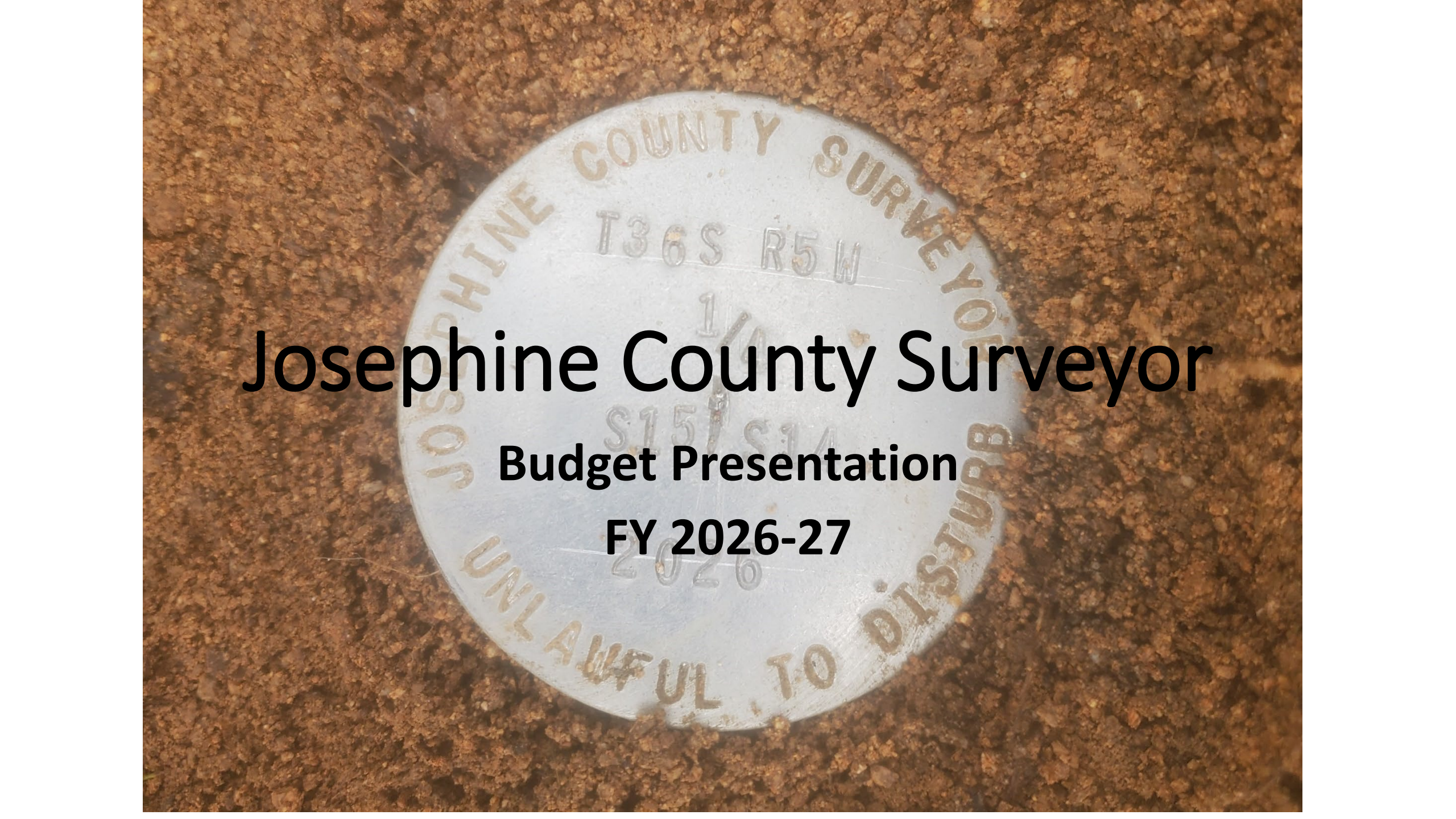
Continue providing county departments with the highest level of customer service and being a resource for regulatory and best practices.



Administer a successful property tax collection program and assist the property owners in Josephine County to promote the most efficient level of service to the public.



Identify and implement more efficient and cost effective processes for tasks handled by Treasury and Tax.



Josephine County Surveyor

Budget Presentation

FY 2026-27

Program Purpose & Function

- County Surveyor Duties established by ORS Chapter 209.
- Store and provide public access to maps, plats, notes, property and survey records of Josephine County, 1850's to present time.
- Reviews and checks all maps submitted for filing for compliance with statutory plat and mapping standard requirements.
- Tasked with preserving & maintaining the original Government Public Land Survey corner monuments and corner references (basis for all property boundaries in County).



Office Structure

Surveyor's Office operates from two funds:

General Fund:

- General office duties; public assistance; maintaining office records & database; general communications.
- Funded by General Fund monies, sale of maps & plats and filing/checking fees charged by our office.

Public Land Corner Preservation Fund (PLCPF):

- Program tasked with maintaining and preserving the original government corner monuments that make up the Public Land Survey System.
- Self-funded through fees collected by recorded documents—to be used specifically for this purpose (ORS 203.148)—no General Fund monies used.



Office Staffing

Surveyor Technician II: 1.0 FTE

Surveyor Technician II: 0.5 FTE

County Surveyor: 0.18 FTE

Total: 1.68 FTE

Office Staff Needs:

-Senior Department Specialist position (0.60 FTE) has been unfilled since March 2025; other staff has filled in for these duties. We need to refill this position.

-Proposed position additional funding required (0.60 FTE):

75% GF (0.45 FTE) \$33,225

25% PLCPF (0.15 FTE) \$11,075

Total \$44,300

<u>FTE Breakdown:</u>	<u>GF</u>	<u>PLCF</u>	<u>Total</u>
Current/as submitted	0.65	1.03	1.68
Proposed w/hire	1.10	1.18	2.28



Budget (proposed)

- General Fund

EXPENSES		
Personnel (@1.68 FTE)	\$	87,200
General office	\$	3,000
ISF	\$	10,000
Insurance	\$	4,500
Facilities Services Operating	\$	7,000
Facilities Capital	\$	3,100
	TOTAL EXPENSES	\$ 114,800
REVENUE (estimated)		
Service Fees & Material Sales	\$	55,500
TOTAL OPERATION REQUIREMENTS	\$	114,800
NET GEN FUND REQUIREMENTS (as submitted)	\$	59,300
SR. DEPT SPECIALIST POSITION (0.60 FTE)		
	Additional cost	\$ 33,225
NET GEN FUND REQUIREMENTS		
	Updated amount (@2.28 FTE)	\$ 92,525

- Public Land Corner Preservation Fund

EXPENSES		
Personnel (@1.68 /1.03 FTE)	\$	114,400
General Office	\$	11,300
ISF	\$	13,500
Insurance	\$	6,600
Facilities Services Operating	\$	7,000
Facilities Capital	\$	3,100
Contingency	\$	36,000
	TOTAL EXPENSES	\$ 191,900
REVENUE (estimated)		
Interest	\$	1,400
Fees Collected	\$	190,500
	TOTAL REVENUE	\$ 191,900
NET GEN FUND REQUIREMENTS (as submitted)	\$	-
SR. DEPT SPECIALIST POSITION (0.60 / 0.15 FTE)		
	Additional cost (25%)	\$ 11,075
NET PLCP FUND REQUIREMENTS		\$ 202,975
NET GEN FUND REQUIREMENTS		\$ -

Budget Goals

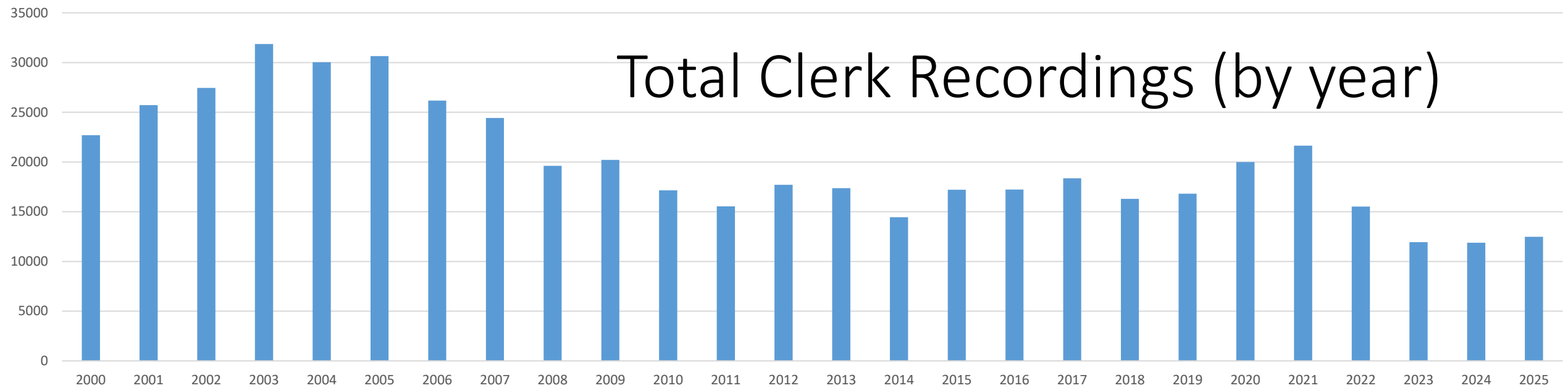
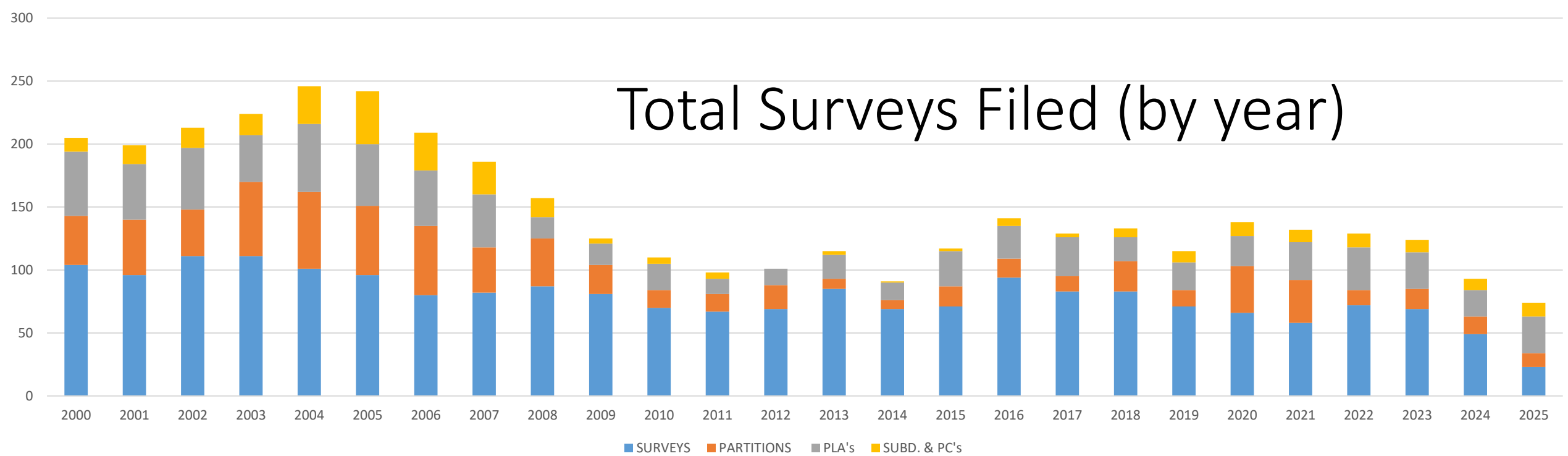
Goal 1: Improve Efficiency, Transparency and Public Engagement

- Enhanced Service Initiative:
 - Public interaction: *assist public with research; ask questions.*
 - Instruction: *educate & inform about our resources.*
 - Guidance: *guide public to the resources or department for their needs.*
 - Service quality: *up-to-date records; knowledgeable staff.*
 - Access: *office is open to public; hours: Tu-Th (9am-12:30pm, 1:30pm-4pm); email, phone; documents in electronic format.*
 - Response time: *answer phone calls & messages asap (staffing); complexity & type of question.*
- Efficiency Initiative:
 - Reduced costs: *attempts to reduce expenses in spite of increased operating costs (personnel, insurance, departmental fees, etc.); reduced open office public hours.*
 - Improved efficiency: *in spite of lack of adequate staff, still functioning although not as efficient; public assistance still maintained—some office duties/procedures falling behind; need to refill Sr. Department Specialist position for better efficiency of operation.*

Budget Goals (cont.)

Goal 2: Ensure Long-Term Financial Sustainability of Core Services

- Funding sources:
 - Self-funded through sale of products, services fees (filing & checking)
 - General Fund monies used/needed to help sustain department operations
 - History of making cuts and reducing department expenses
 - Maintaining core, essential services despite reduced department FTE's
 - Provide resources online—public access (reduced staff time)
- Long-term funding:
 - Goal to be self-funded or nearly self-funded
 - Currently require GF monies for department support of basic operations
 - Annual review of fees for essential services (rising operation costs & dept. charges)
 - Largely dependent on economic climate—not predictable (chart); survey filings declining.



Budget Goals (cont.)

Goal 3: Strategic Investment in Public Safety and Community Infrastructure

- Public Health & Safety
 - Continued, long-term planning for operations of our Public Land Corner Preservation Program.
 - Forms framework for all property boundaries in Josephine County.
 - Maintenance & storage of land survey records—historical “evidence” of property boundaries and corners.
 - Essential component of new facilities—roads, bridges, rights of way, structures, property boundaries, etc.



Where are we/where do we go from here?

- Accomplishments

- Continued operations & public service despite reduced staff and hours (general public, surveyors, county departments—assist with research, provide essential resources and answer questions.
- Maintain efficient & timely turn-around times for map & plat checking.

- Goals

- Refill Senior Department Specialist position.
- Continue to update (scan/digitize) records for public access and preservation.
- Continue to expand & enhance our records availability and website access.
- Prepare & update corner preservation “field book” notes into typed & scanned documents.
- Continue corner preservation operations to visit, refurbish & maintain essential corner monuments and accessories throughout the County.
- Continue and maintain good rapport with land surveyors, county departments & general public.
- Replace fire suppression “water” sprinklers with a “gas” system to prevent damage to our immense paper files and other delicate historic documents.

Adjustments & Budget Challenges

- Economic climate (County & Country) presents challenges (high interest and inflation—cost of living); market dependent.
- Diligent management of office finances
- Maintain essential operations and statutory duties despite reduced staff & hours (continued budget cuts/reductions; increased operation and department costs).
- Decrease in number of surveys & plats filed—less fees collected = reduced office income.
- Filings have declined by approximately 30% since 2022.
- 2026 filings to date at lowest since 2000.
- Future funding not totally predictable; uncertain.
- Actions:
 - Educate staff: *open discussions, changes/adjustments to services, spending & operations.*
 - Conservative spending & analysis: *spending at minimums; continue to evaluate for cost savings.*
 - Fiscal awareness: *open communications with Finance & BCC for updates & changes.*
 - Fee adjustments: *evaluate annually due to increased operation & department costs (personnel, insurance, benefits, supplies, fuel, facilities, etc.).*

Questions?



Community Development Building Safety 2026-27

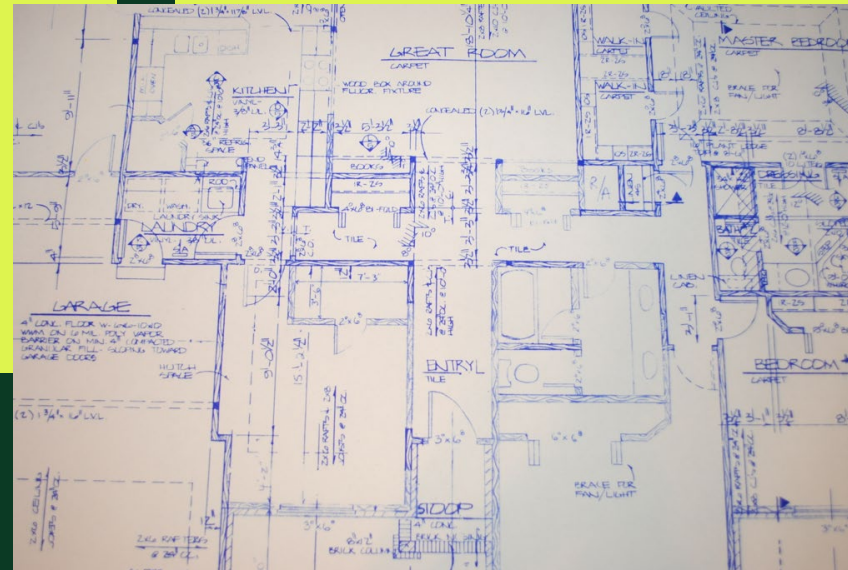


Department Overview



- Building Safety supports safe development and construction standards throughout the county
- Processes building permit applications through plan review and performs inspections
- Ensures compliance with state adopted Building Specialty Codes

- Supports residential and commercial/industrial development
- Protects public health, safety and infrastructure



Personnel (5 FTE)

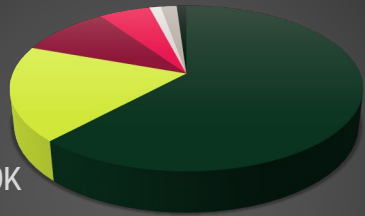
- Building Official
- Deputy Building Official
- Commercial Plans Examiner
- Multi-Certified Building Inspector
- Permit Technician



Dollars and Sense...

- **100% Permit Fee Funded**
- **Permits Types:** Structural, Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing, Manufactured Homes, Special Site Observations

2026-27 Projected Revenue \$807.5K



■ Structural	\$500K
■ Electrical	\$150k
■ Mechanical	\$80k
■ Plumbing	\$45k
■ Manufactured Homes	\$10k
■ Special Site Observations	\$14k
■ CET Admin	\$8.5K

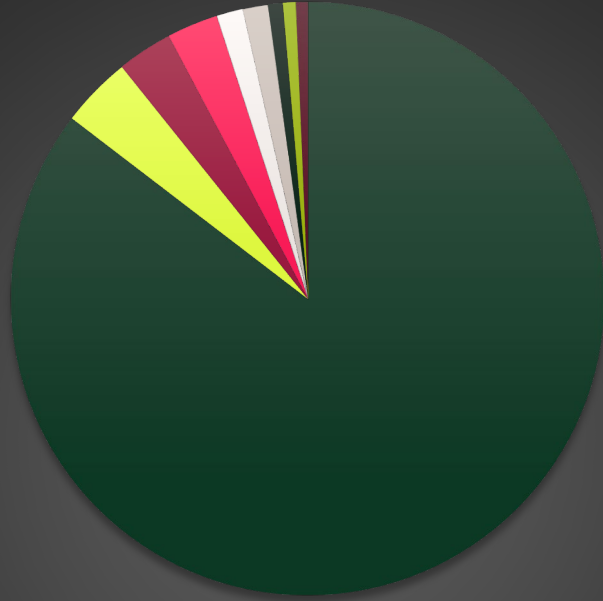
2025-26 Quarterly Revenue Trend



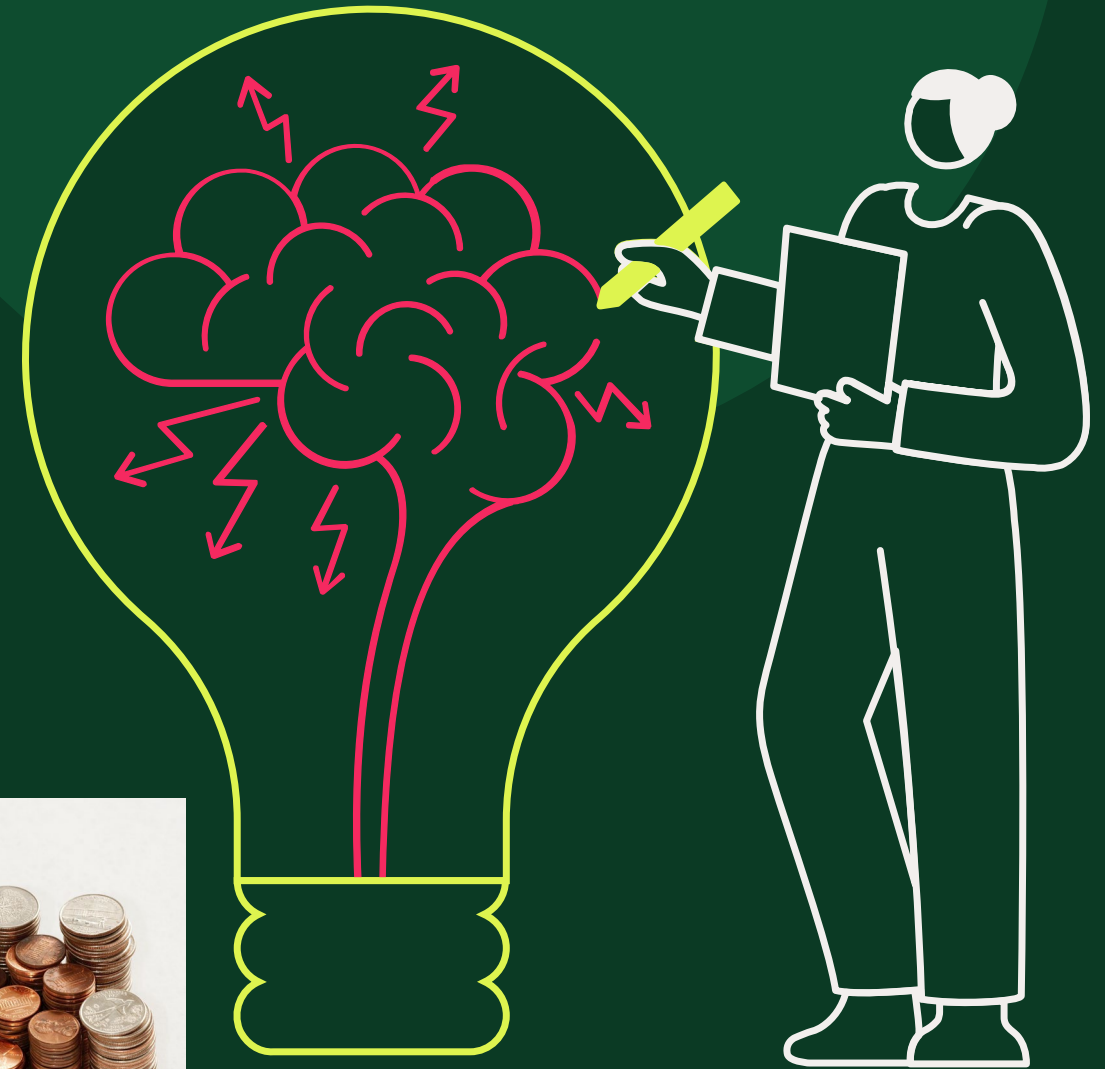
\$0 from General Fund



2026-27 Proposed Expenditures



■ Personnel \$707K	■ Fleet \$32K
■ Tech Subscriptions \$25k	■ Facility \$23k
■ Contract Services \$12k	■ Office/Operating Supplies \$11.5k
■ Communications \$6.4K	■ Education & Training \$6k
■ Travel \$5k	



Navigating the future

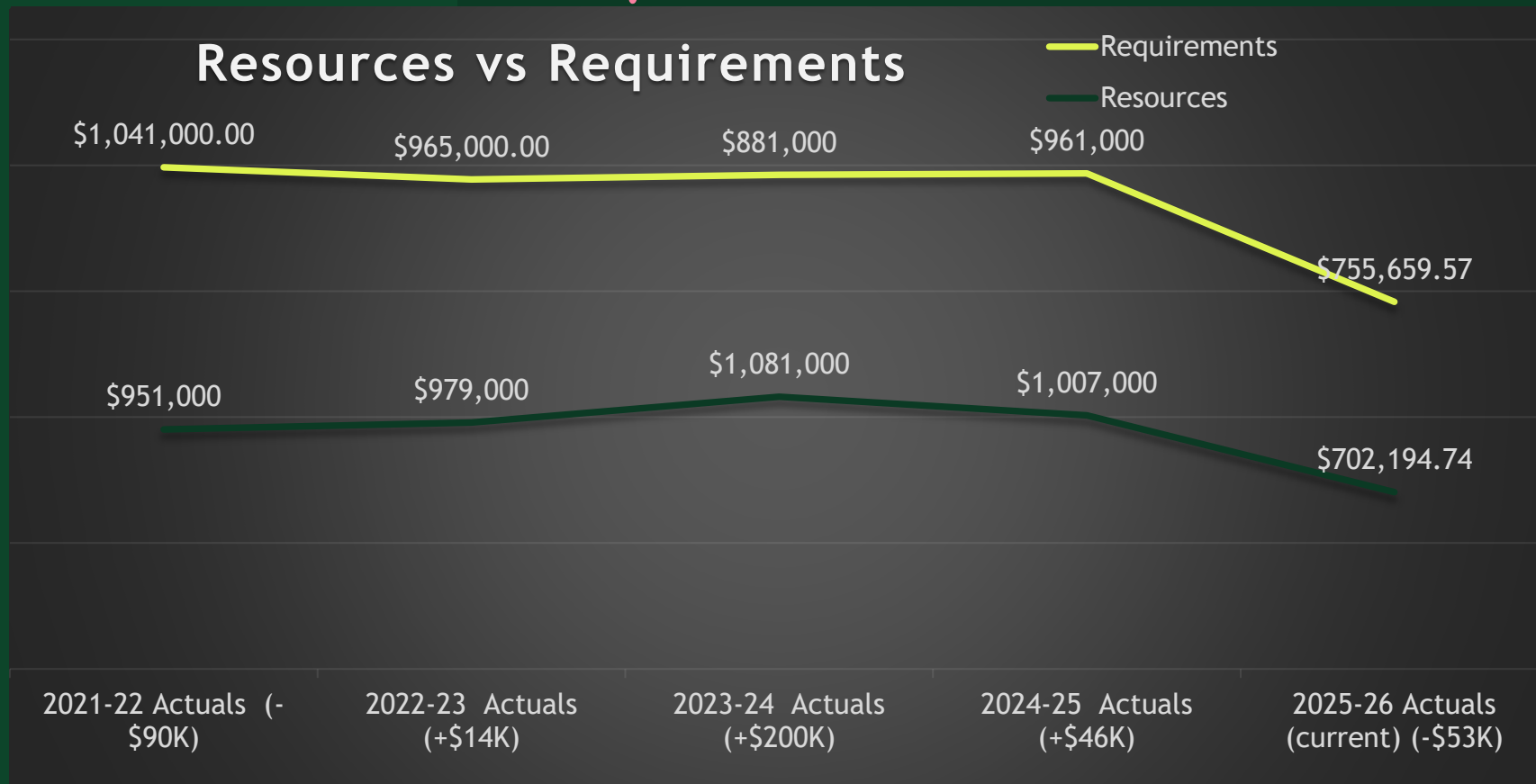
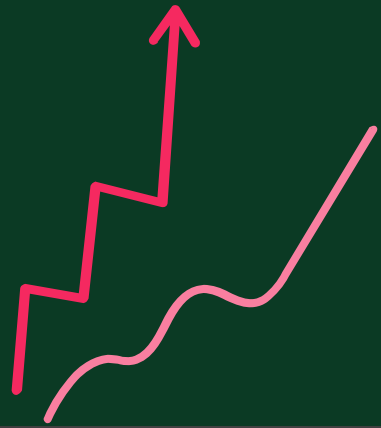
Financial snapshot



Metric	2024-25	2025-26	Change (%)
Education/Training/Travel	\$17,451.34	\$8,537.08	-51%
Fleet	\$37,823.75	\$28,636.81	-24%
Facility	\$45,800	\$41,987	-8%
Contract Services	\$24,186.45	\$4360	-82%
Reserves	\$854,844	\$600,000	-30%



What's the trend?



How does it
measure up?



At your fingertips...

- Major push to make **ALL** (past and present) Building Safety Permits viewable online for public access
- Collaborate with county public information officer to provide regular social media postings with department information and activity to foster public engagement
- Continuous development of our online permitting portal to make it more user-friendly and intuitive so anyone can access and manage permits from anywhere with an internet connection
- Transition to paperless operations. Full digitization of applications, permits, supporting documentation, etc. to improve efficiency and accessibility. Increased utilization of technology to make communication with customers much more efficient, accessible, and reliable





Sustainability



1. Staff cross training and certification to minimize outsourcing of services and overlapping of duties.
2. Technology integration. Explore emerging technologies for potential integration into our operations to improve efficiency.
3. Collaborative partnerships. IGA's with neighboring jurisdictions to provide supporting services.
4. Utilization of virtual training and certification options to drastically reduce travel expenses.

Investing in our Community

Safety is in our name!



- Building Official & Deputy Building Official registered with Oregon State Fire Marshall's Office as the LPC (Local Program Coordinator) for OrSAP (Oregon Safety Assessment Program).
- Building Safety personnel is certified and registered in both California and Oregon for disaster response to perform safety assessments on all structures. (OrSAP/CalOES)
- Collaboration with Sheriff's Office and Public Health to address overlapping safety concerns identified on properties with the goal of restoring compliance with Building Safety Code Standards.
- Collaboration with State Fire Marshall, Local Fire Code Officials, Department of Environmental Quality, and various other agencies that aim to maintain safe conditions and environments for our community.



Ordinance Administrator

- Public outcry for enforcement of codes and standards. Regularly receive citizen complaints related to Building Specialty Code Standards and Land Use Codes
- Dedicated staff member within the department that is responsible for receiving complaints, logging information, coordinating site visits, and working with property owners to achieve and maintain compliance.
- Shared cost 50/50 between Building Safety and Planning Divisions (\$65,200/ea)
- Allocation of resources dedicated to supporting citizens with matters that affect livability, safety, and public nuisances.





Thank you!

Frank Wharregard cbo
Building Official



PLANNING DIVISION 2026-2027 BUDGET



Planning Division – Purpose of Program

The State of Oregon mandates counties of the state to have planning and zoning programs. This mandate, found in **ORS 215**, not only requires a planning and zoning program, but mandates other regulatory and land use laws that counties must enforce on behalf of the state.

In order to provide for orderly growth and development in the community, Josephine County facilitates this mandated function through coordinated programs of Planning and Building Safety. The program's emphasis is on educating and serving the public.

Planning Division – Purpose of Program

The Oregon Department of Land Conservation and Development (DLCD) serves as the oversight agency for the planning program and provides guidance for counties. The Planning Division conducts reviews of land use proposals and issues land use permits under the authority of the **Josephine County Code (JCC) Title 19 – Rural Land Development Code (RLDC)**.

The Community Development Department is also responsible for responding to reports of non-compliance with land use and building codes and County Ordinances. Policies and procedures are established and implemented for investigating complaints to verify, and if founded, work cooperatively with property owners to achieve compliance. The overriding goal is to educate property owners of the purpose for the regulations with hopes of achieving voluntary compliance.

Budget Goal 1 - Improve Efficiency, Transparency, and Public Engagement

Enhance customer service by utilizing SMARTGOV application portal to help customers submit applications at their convenience. Research SMARTGOV capabilities to move towards a more digital application review platform. Update our website to communicate with our citizens on public notices and land use decisions. Update website to allow access to documents and mapping systems to help customers research properties. Proactively communicate with our community through the launch of social media page for our department. This will enable us to more directly communicate with the citizens of Josephine County.

Budget Goal 2 -Ensure Long-Term Financial Sustainability of Core Services

Work with BCC on finding balance between general fund needs and actual cost of service with recovery of fees. Planning has statutory authority to collect fees to cover cost of service. Annual review of Planning fees is a way to help make decisions on budget needs from general fund.



Budget Goal 3 -Strategic Investment in Public Safety and Community Infrastructure

Although we are not directly responsible for public safety as the Sheriff's office, DA, and Jail, our land use code does have requirements for public health and safety. Code requirements for adequate water, septic, and access are key requirements for development in the County. Planning takes this responsibility seriously. Planning's role is more tertiary as more people develop; we make sure carrying capacity of the development allows for future public safety.



Key Performance Indicators:

	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26
Service Levels	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Thru March
<u>Planning Division</u>					
Front Office Customer Contacts			No Data	14808	13003
Permits and Land Use Revenues			\$386,834	\$333,623	\$302,294
Development Permits			630	890	614
Land Use Information Requests/LUCS			192	230	338
New Addresses			68	62	37
Final Plats			30	30	22

Fiscal Year 2025-26 Accomplishments:

- Transferred the Marijuana Compliance program into the Planning Division.
- Continued to develop and modify policies to better serve the community and be more productive in our processes.
- Substantial Reduction in Expenses on Training & Education, Travel, and Fleet Vehicle utilization.
- Consolidation of Resources in order to Refine Allocation of Expense Sharing between Building Safety and Planning Divisions.
- Beginning stages of digitization push to reduce costs of paper, printing, and ink, as well as expensive equipment maintenance and repairs.

Five-Year Vision:

- Expeditious processing of land use and development permits within the confines of the law.
- Updated land use codes that serve the best interest of the community, reflect trends, and facilitate adequate housing opportunities.
- Aid in developing communities that are conflict minimal, more code compliant, safe, offer a better quality of life, and are welcome to visitors and residents.
- Budgetary goal: Find a balance between service level and code requirements to lessen general fund ask through fees for services as opposed to property tax-based revenues.



Budget Details

- Revenue

- Fees = \$425,350
- Econ. Dev. = \$50,000

Total = \$475,350

- Expenditure

- Current 5.5 FTE's = \$692,000
- Office/operations = \$85,200

Total = \$777,500

Budget Details

- Resource/Requirement

$\$475,350 - \$777,500 = -\$302,150$ General Fund need

This is \$87,450 more than current fiscal year's GF need (\$214,700). This amount is the result of adding 1 FTE this year. This position has assisted with application and permit processing and manages a portion of the newly acquired marijuana Annual Compliance Program (CH. 19.99B, JCC).

2026-2027 Budget summary conclusion

Efficiency and Sustainability remain at the core of the Planning Division for each budget season. Allowances have been made in the process of projecting fees for our 2026-2027 fiscal year to reduce expenditures in order to close the gap between Revenue and Expenses.

2026-2027 Budget summary conclusion

Historically, the Community Development Department has been fiscally dependent on economic highs and lows. The Planning Division is responsible for continuity of services but relies heavily on annual support from the budget committee for General Fund contribution. There is no way to completely predict fluctuations in the development industry. However, we must be able to provide mandated services at a level to comply with State statutes and the public's needs. Moving forward, the Board of County Commissioners may want to explore fee increases in order to more precisely align actual cost of services provided with fees collected.

Community Development - Ordinance Administrator

- The Planning Division is aware of the need for an Ordinance Administrator to handle citizen complaints.
- Having this position split between Building Safety and Planning would be ideal.
- This position would need BCC approval as well as funds allocated through the Budget Committee.

Questions?